

Mobile phone etiquette has become an important issue. People speaking loudly on their mobiles and cells ringing merrily in the middle of a movie at the theatre are just a couple of instances where mobiles become a nuisance. Certain places that prohibit the use of cell phones even install 'jamming' equipment to prevent them working.

7.8 Do Not Use Areas

Mobile phones are banned on existing aircraft for fear that they might interfere with a plane's navigation system as they attempt to log on to terrestrial networks. While experts claim that mobile phones on an aircraft can interfere with the communication systems of an aeroplane, there is no rock-solid proof. Nevertheless, cell phone use is prohibited on all commercial aircraft - etiquette, too, demands that cell phones be kept on silent, or at least on low volume, so as to not disturb co-passengers.

Cell phones in the air could also occupy multiple cell towers on the ground and cause interference with calls taking place on the ground. In July this year, three US government agencies raised safety concerns about the use of mobile phone on airplanes in-flight. Law enforcement officials said high-power mobile systems could allow terrorists to better coordinate their efforts with cohorts on the ground, and thus set off bombs on airplanes.

However, in September this year, two European airlines agreed to introduce a voice and text service for cell phones in separate three-month trial runs starting in 2006. The planes will be the first to allow passengers to make and receive calls with their own cell phones while on board.

Another area where cell phones are asked to be switched off is near petrol pumps. People are repeatedly warned against using cellular phones near gasoline fumes. However, no media or scientific reports support such claims. However, there were certain incidents in the United States where mobile phones were blamed for